Breaking News

from Washington and beyond

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Todd Blanche Says Everyone Else Is Confused About DOJ Independence

Apparently, it's supposed to run according to the president's whims.



TOM BRENNER/THE WASHINGTON POST/BLOOMBERG/GETTY IMAGES

Ellie Quinlan Houghtaling /
October 21, 2026 / 2:00 p.m. ET

Attorney General Todd Blanche's understanding of the Justice Department is a stark departure from the law enforcement agency's historic position within the federal government.

Speaking with the *New York Post* podcast Wednesday, Blanche boldly declared that he works "for President Trump."

"There was this misperception that there's this separation and independence between the Department of Justice and the White House, and everybody likes to champion that, and they accused me of not suffering from independence," Blanche said. "I don't."

> Attorney General Todd Blanche says there's a "misperception that there's this separation and independence between the Department of Justice and the White House." "I work for President Trump."
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> [image or embed]
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> — Ken Klippenstein (@kenklippenstein.bsky.social) October 21, 2026 at 12:38 PM

Contrary to Blanche's opinion, the Justice Department is supposed to be independent and free from presidential interference. That's been true since at least Watergate, after which the agency established interdepartmental policies and new political norms to distance its operations from the White House.

But that started to shift in 2024, when the Supreme Court sided with Donald Trump to expand his presidential immunity. At the time, Chief Justice John Roberts penned a majority decision that effectively transformed the Justice Department into an arm to be leveraged by the Oval Office, opening communication channels between the federal law enforcement agency and the presidency for all future investigations.

"The president may discuss potential investigations and prosecutions with his Attorney General and other Justice Department officials to carry out his constitutional duty to 'take care that the laws be faithfully executed,'" Roberts wrote in his majority opinion.

Since then, Trump has repeatedly used the Justice Department for his own personal gain, directing prosecutors to lead his retribution campaign, to investigate election records, and to strong-arm other federal institutions.

Under Blanche's supervision, the agency has also brushed off potential investigations into dubious activity by Trump and his family members. Last month, Blanche said he had no interest in examining the Russian ties to Donald Trump Jr., even after a Putin-connected Russian oligarch spent hundreds of thousands of dollars on Trump Jr.'s wedding.

Read more about Blanche:
Todd Blanche Crashes Out About Media Ban After Trump Bars CNN Again

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FCC Threatens Broadcasters Over Polls Predicting Disaster for GOP

The Federal Communications Commission is ramping up Trump's war on "fake polls" as it looks to be a bloodbath for Republicans this election.

Donald Trump speaks to Brendan Carr as they attend a SpaceX Starship rocket test flight on November 19, 2024, in Brownsville, Texas.

BRANDON BELL/GETTY IMAGES

Donald Trump speaks to Brendan Carr as they attend a SpaceX Starship rocket test flight on November 19, 2024, in Brownsville, Texas.

Hafiz Rashid /

October 21, 2026 / 1:33 p.m. ET

The chairman of the Federal Communications Commission is openly attacking media outlets for what he describes as "entirely Fake Polls and Suppression Polls."

"During this election season, there has been a significant surge in entirely Fake Polls and Suppression Polls designed to do nothing more than interfere with the regular functioning of the electoral process and alter the normal patterns of voter turnout and enthusiasm," Brendan Carr posted on X Wednesday morning. "Many journalists and broadcasters have been amplifying or airing these Polls without regard to basic journalistic ethics and without informing the public that those Polls lack a scientific, accurate, or even real basis."

Carr didn't mention any polls or coverage in particular, but multiple broadcast outlets have reported and continue to report on President Trump's historically low poll numbers, including conservative outlet Fox News. Carr went on to give an ominous warning to broadcasters who run afoul of his and Trump's opinions.

"The FCC takes these issues seriously. Broadcasters are prohibited by the terms of their federal licenses from engaging in News Distortion or promoting Broadcast Hoaxes. It is important that broadcasters comply with their public interest obligations," the post continued. "Broadcasters are advised to avoid engaging in News Distortions or running Broadcast Hoaxes by airing Polls that would violate their regulatory obligations."

It's an alarming, but not altogether surprising attack on the free press from Carr, who co-authored the archconservative Project 2025 manifesto and has waged unprecedented attacks on broadcast outlets on Trump's behalf since his return to office. Carr has ordered the review

of the broadcast licenses for eight ABC TV stations, which the network claimed in a regulatory lawsuit was because of "the content and viewpoints expressed on ABC network programs." The threat to ABC's licenses came days after Jimmy Kimmel made a joke about Trump and Melania.

Carr's new warning, less than two weeks before November's midterm elections, is intended to send a chilling message to broadcast outlets about their coverage. It also hints that Trump and his henchman might blame a poor showing by Republicans on the media—and then attempt unconstitutional actions.

Editor's Pick:
Transcript: Fox News Poll Shocker Is an Absolute Disaster for Trump

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Green Card Holder Arrested in Trump's Voter Fraud Crackdown Speaks Out

Omar Muñoz is a lawful permanent resident and denies any wrongdoing.

Omar Muñoz

SCREENGRAB/FOX 11

Omar Muñoz

Hafiz Rashid /
October 21, 2026 / 12:16 p.m. ET

The Trump administration's crackdown on supposed noncitizen voting led to 11 people being arrested in California, one of whom was a 72-year-old man who says he has never voted in a U.S. election.

Omar Muñoz, who was born in Belize, told Fox 11 Los Angeles that he is a legal permanent resident of the U.S. and has never registered to vote. Federal prosecutors, however, claim that he illegally registered to vote in Los Angeles County in 2019 and voted in four elections.

"No, I didn't register to vote," Muñoz told the TV station. He was not expecting to be arrested for anything. "I looked around and said, 'I'm not a killer.'"

> **Matthew Seedorff**
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> NEW: One of 11 people arrested in California's voter fraud crackdown tells me he ever registered to vote or cast a ballot.
>
> Omar Muñoz, 72, says someone may have used his identity. Federal prosecutors allege he registered and voted in four elections.
>
> Watch on X

Muñoz said he could be a victim of identity theft, as someone once used his name and Social Security number to work in a chocolate factory. But the Department of Justice's lists of noncitizen voters have been full of errors, particularly in Los Angeles County.

Last week, the DOJ sent a list of 20,000 purported noncitizens who are registered to vote to county election officials as well as California's secretary of state. But in a court filing, county officials attested that the list was inaccurate, with only 7,000 people on it actually having Los Angeles County addresses. On top of that, it appeared to contain a lot of U.S.-born citizens.

The Trump administration is clearly sowing chaos and fear ahead of November's midterm elections. The president's underlings have demanded voter rolls from every state, taking legal action when states refuse. Acting on MAGA's conspiracy theories, they've seized voting machines and ballots. Muñoz appears to be an innocent bystander in their efforts.

"Politics is a nice chess game if you know how to play. Unfortunately, they used me as one of their props," Muñoz told Fox 11.

Editor's Pick:
DOJ's "Noncitizen Voters" List Filled With People Born in America

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Armed Federal Agents Go Door to Door to Hunt for Noncitizen Voters

Armed officers are knocking on people's doors ahead of the midterms.

HSI NORCAL/X

Malcolm Ferguson /
October 21, 2026 / 11:53 a.m. ET

Armed federal agents are spending the days leading up to midterms going door to door asking people their immigration and voter registration status.

CBS News reported Wednesday that the draconian crackdown—a combination of President Trump's mass deportation effort and his desperate attempt to manufacture proof of election fraud—was already underway in multiple states, having accelerated last month.

"HSI is actively rooting out and investigating election fraud wherever it can be found," a Department of Homeland Security spokesperson told CBS, using an acronym for Immigration and Custom Enforcement's Homeland Security Investigations arm. "Under President Trump, HSI is committed to restoring integrity to our election systems and ensuring that American citizens and only American citizens are electing American leaders."

HSI Kansas City
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AMERICAN ELECTIONS ARE FOR AMERICANS.

HSI is committed to protecting the integrity of our elections by investigating voter election fraud and holding violators accountable.



5:36 PM · Sep 1, 2026 · **12.6K** Views

This effort can be traced back to June, when DHS ordered ICE to specifically target noncitizens who were allegedly voting in elections. The department has claimed that there could be as many as 250,000 fraudulent voters—even though only 156 people have been charged thus far. And that 250,000 number is widely debated, as states say the federal government gave them lists of noncitizen voters riddled with inaccuracies.

The home visits have increased regardless. On Monday, DHS announced that they arrested 11 people in Los Angeles, all of them green card holders. One of those arrested, a 72-year-old Belizean man, said he had never voted and couldn't remember having registered to vote.

This gestapo-level action was part of the plan all along, especially as Trump grasps for any possible way to suppress votes against him and his party in November. This will not only lead to unlawful arrests, but it will also have a chilling effect on legal voters who may be naturalized citizens, or who just happen to not be white.

"Once again, this has nothing to do with immigration enforcement. Trump has turned DHS into his own federal police force," former Biden immigration adviser Andrea R. Flores wrote

on X. “Whether he deploys them to find fraud, harass nonprofits, or question naturalized citizens, he keeps expanding the scope of their duties.”

Editor’s Pick:
DOJ’s “Noncitizen Voters” List Filled With People Born in America

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Florida’s Early Voting Shows Huge Swings Towards Democrats

People are clearly pissed at Republicans.

JOE RAEDLE/GETTY IMAGES

Ellie Quinlan Houghtaling /
October 21, 2026 / 11:44 a.m. ET

Even in the deep red state of Florida, Americans are feeling a bit more liberal.

Republicans are still projected to win the Sunshine State, but by a much smaller margin: Early voting results out of Florida revealed a massive Democratic shift compared to the last election cycle.

On the first day of early voting in 2024, Republicans led by 24.7 percentage points. On Monday, the party led by a mere fraction of a percentage point—marking a 24.4 percent shift toward the Democratic Party.

That pattern remained true through the second day of early voting, as well. At the same point in the race in 2024, Republicans held a 26.1 percent advantage. On Tuesday, they were ahead by just 2.4 percent, a 23.8 percent shift, according to data shared by VoteHub's Zachary Donnini.

"I expect this shift to narrow substantially, but yesterday was another decent day for Democrats in FL," Donnini wrote on X Wednesday morning.

So far, more than 1.06 million ballots have been cast across Florida. Roughly 6.1 million remain.

Florida isn't the only state feeling the changing tide. A blue wave is expected to sweep the country this year, potentially transforming both the House and Senate following an abysmal second-term performance by President Donald Trump.

A spate of election-bound MAGA personalities have already broken from Trump and his agenda in an attempt to curry favor with their local electorates. The growing list includes Florida Representatives Maria Elvira Salazar and Byron Donalds (the latter of whom is running for Florida governor), Maine Republican gubernatorial candidate Bobby Charles, and Texas Republican congressional candidate Carlos De La Cruz.

Some hopeful office seekers have even stripped their websites and campaign materials of Trump's name, taking advice that the White House offered in July when staffers explicitly encouraged midterm-bound Republicans to split from Trump and his sinking reputation.

Top issues weighing down Trump's popularity include the seemingly endless Iran war, the rising cost of living, an economy and supply chain thrown out of whack by the president's reckless tariffs, the cost of health care, and the encroachment of artificial intelligence and the industry's data centers into American communities—a hot topic that Trump has unequivocally backed.

Nonetheless, Trump has insisted that the midterms should once again be a referendum on his popularity—a detail that isn't likely to help anyone currently on the campaign trail.

Read more about early voting:
Texas's 5 Biggest Counties Blow Early Voting Records Out of the Water

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